

Catholic Social Teaching BME2, June, 2025/ Normal Session Exam

By Dr. Thomas Ahoussi, sj

Instructions

Each student must answer a total of five (5) questions from the 13 proposed in a reasoned manner. Question No. 6 is mandatory. The rest is optional. No student can answer more than five questions. It is not necessary to copy the question. Simply indicate the question's number before answering it. *The exam lasts three hours.*

Questions

- ✓ 1°. What is Catholic Social Teaching? Explain the reasons justifying a Social Teaching of the Church and expose its methodology.
- 2° What do you mean by principles of Catholic Social Teaching? Mention five (5) and explain each of them.
- ✓ 3° The first social encyclical, *Rerum Novarum*, was written in the context of the industrial revolution of the 19th century. It rejects both liberalism and socialism. Develop this idea.
- 4° Develop the idea of objective work and subjective work elaborated by Pope John Paul II in the encyclical *Laborem exercens*.
- 5° According to Michael Novak democratic capitalism is the most effective political-economic system for ensuring the prosperity of nations. Explain this idea.
- 6° After its condemnation of capitalism (economic liberalism) in *Rerum Novarum*, the Social Teaching of the Church adopts a more complex point of view toward this economic theory in *Centesimus Annus* (n°42). Expose the position of the Church on capitalism in *Centesimus Annus* and explain in which sense this is an argument that value the market economy.
- 7° What is the position of the church on private property? How is that position related to the principle of Universal Destination of Good? (See *Centesimus Annus*)
- 8° What is the meaning and scope of integral development? (See *Populorum progressio*)
- 9° What is the meaning of integral ecology in *Laudato Si*? How is this idea related to the principle of common good?
- 10° Explain how Pius XI defend the relationship between Labor and Capital. Sustain your answer by drawing your argument from the content of *Quadragesimo Anno*.
- 11° What is the legitimacy of the church intervention in Economic and social matters. Illustrate your answers by drawing your argument from *Rerum Novarum* of Leon XIII and *Quadragesimo Anno* of Pius XI.
- 12° After developing the content of the three forms of justice, show how distributive justice helps to give shape to the principle of preferential option for the poor.
- 13° In which sense Catholic Social Teaching is relevant in the curriculum of the Bachelor's degree in Management Economics? Argue your answer.